

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 976

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to commemorate the Kurdish New Year's celebration of Newroz.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pride in recognizing those significant cultural observances that enrich our State and uphold cherished traditions; and

WHEREAS, Nashville is home to the largest Kurdish population in the United States, with an estimated 15,000 to 20,000 Kurdish residents; and

WHEREAS, the Kurdish New Year's celebration of Newroz coincides with the Spring Equinox and is a festival celebrating the beginning of spring; and

WHEREAS, the Kurdish Newroz, derived from the Kurdish words *new* and *roz*, meaning "new day" or "new sun," marks the start of spring and symbolizes renewal, hope, and freedom among the Kurdish people; and

WHEREAS, Newroz is considered to be the most important festival in Kurdish culture and has come to represent new beginnings and an opportunity to support the Kurdish cause; and

WHEREAS, typically falling on March 21st, Newroz traces its origins to ancient Zoroastrian traditions celebrated for thousands of years and remains deeply rooted in Kurdish identity and history; and

WHEREAS, this year, Newroz will be celebrated from March 21st to April 1st; and

WHEREAS, during Newroz, families and friends come together to enjoy traditional foods, music, dance, fireworks, singing, and poetry recitations; and

WHEREAS, spring flowers, such as tulips, hyacinths, and pussy willows are cut; new clothes are worn; and pottery is smashed for good luck; and

WHEREAS, families often spend the day in the country enjoying nature and the fresh growth of spring; and

WHEREAS, on the eve of Newroz in southern and eastern Kurdistan, bonfires are lit to symbolize the passing of the dark season, winter, and the arrival of spring, the season of light; and

WHEREAS, during the thirteen days after Newroz, families visit one another and the graves of deceased relatives and seek to resolve any conflicts or misunderstandings carried over from the previous year; and

WHEREAS, the observance of Newroz by the Kurdish community in Tennessee underscores the strength and vitality of the cultural traditions that flourish within our State; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we join with Tennessee's Kurdish community in commemorating the Kurdish New Year's celebration of Newroz, acknowledging its rich cultural traditions and significance, and extending our warmest wishes for a joyful, meaningful, and hopeful new year to all those who celebrate.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.